

5.1.2 How the impact of risks and challenges can be minimised/overcome

- ☐ Use of experienced advisors
- ☐ Contingency planning
- ☐ Detailed research
- ☐ Attending training courses

Examples of detailed research may include:

- competitors
- likely consumer demand
- costs
- economic conditions

Marking criteria

[Section 6.4](#) provides full information on how to mark the NEA units and apply the marking criteria. The marking criteria descriptor words are further explained in [Appendix B](#).

The tables below contain the marking criteria for the tasks for this unit. If a student's work does not meet any Mark Band 1 (MB1) criteria for the task, you must award zero marks for that task.

Unit R068 – Topic Area 1: Market research		
MB1: 1–4 marks	MB2: 5–8 marks	MB3: 9–12 marks
Identifies the overall aims of the market research. Creates market research tools with limited effectiveness, resulting in completed research outcomes with limited relevance to the aims. Basic outline of the sampling method(s) used, evidencing limited understanding. Collates the results and uses basic method(s) to briefly present the research outcomes. Limited review of the collated results.	A sound explanation of the overall aims of the market research. Creates <u>two</u> mostly effective market research tools, resulting in completed research outcomes with some relevance to the aims. Sound justification of the sampling method(s) used, evidencing some understanding. Collates the results and uses mostly effective method(s) to present the research outcomes. Sound review of the collated results.	A comprehensive explanation of the overall aims of the market research. Creates <u>two</u> comprehensive , accurate and fully effective market research tools resulting in completed research outcomes that are fully relevant to the aims. Comprehensive justification of the sampling method(s) used, evidencing clear understanding. Collates the results and uses effective method(s) to present the research outcomes. Comprehensive review of the collated results.

Unit R068 – Topic Area 2: How to identify a customer profile		
MB1: 1–2 marks	MB2: 3–4 marks	MB3: 5–6 marks
Describes limited features of a specific customer profile using market segmentation techniques. Limited justification of the selected customer profile.	Describes some features of a specific customer profile using market segmentation techniques. Some justification of the selected customer profile, with reference to the market research findings.	Describes in detail the features of a specific customer profile using market segmentation techniques. Detailed justification of the selected customer profile, with reference to the market research findings.

MB1: 1–3 marks	MB2: 4–6 marks	MB3: 7–9 marks
Creates a basic outline of a design mix with limited/no reference to the customer profile and market research findings.	Creates an outline of an appropriate design mix with some justification.	Creates an outline of an appropriate design mix with comprehensive justification.
Generate a product design with limited use of a creative technique.	Generate a product design with adequate use of a creative technique.	Generate a product design with effective use of a creative technique.
Limited description of how the design mix and market research findings have informed your design.	Sound description of how the design mix and market research findings have informed your design.	Comprehensive description of how the design mix and market research findings have informed your design.

Unit R068 – Topic Area 3: Develop a product proposal

MB1: 1–3 marks	MB2: 4–6 marks	MB3: 7–9 marks
Limited or no reference is made to the self-assessment and the verbal and written feedback gathered. A basic summary of the strengths and/or weaknesses of the design proposal is produced.	Some reference is made to the self-assessment and the verbal and written feedback gathered. A sound summary of the strengths and weaknesses of the design proposal is produced.	Detailed reference is made to the self-assessment and the verbal and written feedback gathered. A comprehensive summary of the strengths and weaknesses of the design proposal is produced.
Design modifications, with limited relevance to self-assessment and feedback, are carried out with basic description.	Design modifications, with sound relevance to self-assessment and feedback, are carried out with adequate description.	Design modifications, with clear relevance to self-assessment and feedback, are carried out with full description.
Basic reasons for the final design are provided.	Some explanation of the reasons for the final design is given.	The reasons for the final design are fully justified.

Unit R068 – Topic Area 4: Review whether a business proposal is financially viable - Part One

MB1: 1–3 marks	MB2: 4–6 marks	MB3: 7–9 marks
Identifies a limited range of costs relating to the product design. Variable cost calculations for the product design are completed, with limited accuracy .	Identifies some relevant costs relating to the product design. Variable cost calculations for the product design are mostly accurately completed.	Identifies all relevant costs relating to the product design. Variable cost calculations for the product design are accurately completed.
Predicts a number of units sold in the first month showing no/basic reasoning.	Predicts a number of units sold in the first month showing sound reasoning.	Predicts a number of units sold in the first month showing detailed reasoning.
Selects a pricing strategy and selling price for the product design. Reasoning has no/limited reference to the identified customer profile.	Selects an appropriate pricing strategy and selling price for the product design. Reasoning has some reference to the identified customer profile.	Selects an appropriate pricing strategy and selling price for the product design. Reasoning is clearly focused on the identified customer profile.
Calculates the predicted total costs and predicted total profit for the first month with limited accuracy .	Calculates the predicted total costs and the predicted total profit for the first month with some accuracy .	Calculates the predicted total costs and predicted total profit for the first month accurately .

Unit R068 – Topic Area 4: Review whether a business proposal is financially viable - Part Two

MB1: 1–3 marks	MB2: 4–6 marks	MB3: 7–9 marks
Applies the break-even formula to calculate break-even for the business proposal, with limited accuracy . Shows a basic understanding of the results.	Applies the break-even formula to calculate break-even for the business proposal with some accuracy . Shows a sound understanding of the results.	Applies the break-even formula to calculate break-even for the business proposal accurately . Shows a clear understanding of the results.
Provides a basic outline of the impact of a change in price on the break-even level of sales for the business proposal.	Provides a sound description of the impact of a change in price on the break-even level of sales for the business proposal.	Provides a comprehensive description of the impact of a change in price on the break-even level of sales for the business proposal.
The financial viability of the business proposal is assessed with limited accuracy and detail.	Adequate evaluation of the financial viability of the business proposal.	Full evaluation of the financial viability of the business proposal.

MB1: 1–2 marks	MB2: 3–4 marks	MB3: 5–6 marks
Risks and challenges involved with producing and launching a new product are identified. Basic links made between the business proposal and risks and challenges faced with limited explanation. Little/no reference made to how these risks and challenges could be minimised/overcome.	Sound explanation of the risks and challenges involved with producing and launching a new product. Adequate evaluation of the impact that risks and challenges faced may have on the success of the business proposal. Some reference made to how these risks and challenges could be minimised/overcome.	Comprehensive and realistic explanation of the risks and challenges involved with producing and launching a new product. Fully evaluates the impact that risks and challenges faced may have on the success of the business proposal. Detailed reference made to how these risks and challenges could be minimised/overcome.

Assessment guidance

Task	Assessment guidance
Task 1	- Students must carry out both primary and secondary research. One primary research tool and one secondary research tool must be created and used. Students must also gather both qualitative and quantitative data. - Students must use the secondary research carried out e.g. a screen shot of a company website is not an appropriate example of using a secondary research tool. Any information from a website must be presented e.g. in a table/graph, to provide the evidence that the tool has been used. - Students should clearly reference any secondary sources of information used. - Students must collate the findings of their research and then present this using at least one appropriate method. Students are not required to explain the method(s) used. - The final review should be about analysing the overall results of Task 1.
Task 2	- Students must describe their chosen customer profile based on their own market research findings. Their description should include reference to market segmentation types (R067 2.5). - Although more than one student may choose a similar customer profile, it is not expected to see the same outputs within the cohort as their description should align to their individual market research.
Task 3	- Students must produce one design idea. Evidence must be provided of the use of one creative technique. - If students have issues with drawing, they may find it easier to download a template from the internet which they can annotate. They can be reminded that drawing skills are not assessed.
Task 4	Students must provide evidence of the verbal and written feedback gained from different individuals and their own self-assessment.
Task 5	- Students must independently perform all calculations for this task although the formulae can be provided. - Students must choose one pricing strategy and explain why it is appropriate for their design. There is no requirement to explain other pricing strategies.

Topic Area		Topic Area	
1	Market research	2	Market research to target a specific customer
4	Review whether a business proposal is financially viable	3	What makes a product financially viable

More information about synoptic assessment within this qualification can be found in [section 5.2 Synoptic assessment](#).